

AI Hackathon 2026

Forman Computer Science Club
ASL Sign Language Classification

Phase 1 — Model Training

Saturday 8:00 PM → Monday 12:00 PM

Timeline

Day	Time	Activity
Saturday	8:00 PM	Competition opens. Download dataset, start training, begin submitting. Max 5 per day.
Sunday	Full day	Continue training, tuning, and submitting.
Monday	Deadline 12 PM	Final submission cutoff. Hidden test set revealed. Final leaderboard computed. Top 10 announced.

Monday 12:00 PM is a hard deadline. No late submissions accepted.

Dataset

87,000 training images across 29 classes: A–Z, space, del, and nothing. Available on Kaggle.

Model Training

You are free to use any approach; CNN, landmark-based, or otherwise. The dataset, problem type, and deployment target should inform your architectural choices.

Submission Format

Field	Requirement
Columns	image_id, label
Label values	A–Z, space, del, nothing
File format	CSV (.csv)
Max submissions	5 per day
Deadline	Monday 12:00 PM

What to Submit by Monday 12:00 PM

- Prediction CSV via Kaggle
- Top two Kaggle notebooks used for your final submissions

Phase 2 — Build & Present

Monday 12:00 PM → Tuesday | Top 10 teams only

Enhancement

Enhance your project beyond the classifier to make it useful to a real person. Some directions you could take, but not limited to:

Direction	What it means
Live webcam demo	Model runs on a real camera in real time. No pre-recorded clips.
Word spelling interface	Hold a sign to commit a letter. Build a sentence live on screen.
Two-way bridge	Hearing user types; deaf user sees signs. Deaf user signs; hearing user sees text.
Sign learning platform	Live feedback on hand position and technique. Teaches, not just classifies.

Judging Criteria

Criterion	What we look for	Weight
Final leaderboard	Accuracy on Kaggle.	25%
Live demo	Real camera, real-time. No pre-recorded clips.	25%
Creative extension	Meaningful enhancement beyond classification.	25%
Presentation	Clarity, depth, Q&A.	25%
Bonus: deployment	Publicly accessible via URL.	+5%

Tuesday Presentation

5 minutes per team, followed by 3 minutes Q&A. Must include:

- What your model does and how it works, explain the AI, not just the result
- A live demo, judges will interact with it directly
- What you tried that did not work
- What you would build next

What to Submit by Tuesday Morning

- GitHub repository with a readme covering your approach, model, and results
- Deployment link (if applicable)